

10 Business Processes You Can Automate with AI

A practical playbook for family business owners

Most small businesses are still doing these tasks manually — outreach, onboarding, invoicing, scheduling, and support. This guide shows exactly which tools automate each process, what they cost, and what results to expect.

WHAT'S INSIDE:

- ✓ 10 automation playbooks — one per business process
- ✓ Tools with real prices and how to use them today
- ✓ The problem, solution, and result for each process
- ✓ Works for any small or family-owned business

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01

Lead Generation & Outreach

Find and reach your ideal clients — automatically

THE PROBLEM

You spend hours searching for leads, sending connection requests, and writing follow-ups — manually.

TOOLS TO USE

Apollo.io

Build your lead list by industry, size & location
\$49/mo

Claude AI

Personalize every message at scale
\$20/mo

THE SOLUTION

An AI outreach agent finds your ICP, sends personalized messages, and follows up on autopilot.

Expandi

Automate LinkedIn outreach & follow-ups
\$99/mo

Instantly.ai

Cold email sequences with high deliverability
\$37/mo

RESULT

400+ touchpoints/month with zero manual effort

02

Content & Social Media

Create and post content without the daily grind

THE PROBLEM

Creating consistent content takes time you don't have — and an inconsistent presence hurts your brand.

TOOLS TO USE

Claude AI

Generate posts, blogs & captions in your voice
\$20/mo

Canva AI

Design visuals without a designer
Free / \$13/mo

THE SOLUTION

AI drafts posts, captions, and articles based on your brand voice. Scheduling tools post them automatically.

Buffer

Schedule posts across all platforms
\$15/mo

RESULT

3x more content output with 80% less time

03

Client Onboarding

Welcome new clients without lifting a finger

THE PROBLEM

Every new client means emails, forms, contracts, and intro calls — all done manually every time.

THE SOLUTION

Automate the entire onboarding flow: welcome email, contract, intake form, and first meeting — triggered the moment a deal closes.

TOOLS TO USE

HubSpot CRM

Trigger onboarding workflows automatically

Free / \$15/mo

DocuSign / PandaDoc

Send and sign contracts instantly

\$15/mo

Zapier / Make

Connect all tools in one automated flow

Free / \$9/mo

Calendly

Auto-schedule the kickoff call

Free / \$10/mo

RESULT

Onboarding from days to under 1 hour

04

Scheduling & Booking

Eliminate back-and-forth and no-shows

THE PROBLEM

Email chains to find meeting times waste 30+ minutes per booking — and no-shows hurt your pipeline.

THE SOLUTION

Let clients book directly into your calendar. Reminders and confirmations go out automatically.

TOOLS TO USE

Calendly

Share a link, clients pick a time

Free / \$10/mo

Google Calendar + Zapier

Auto-sync and notify your team

Free

Acuity Scheduling

Booking with payments and intake forms

\$16/mo

RESULT

Save 5+ hrs/month on scheduling alone

05

Invoicing & Contracts

Get paid faster with zero paperwork

THE PROBLEM

Manual invoicing is slow, error-prone, and awkward to follow up on when payments are late.

THE SOLUTION

Auto-generate invoices when a project is created, send payment reminders, and track status — all without touching it.

TOOLS TO USE

QuickBooks / FreshBooks

Auto-invoicing and payment tracking
From \$17/mo

Stripe

Collect payments with auto-receipts
2.9% + 30¢

PandaDoc

Proposals, contracts & e-signatures
\$19/mo

RESULT

Get paid 2x faster, zero manual follow-up

06

CRM & Follow-Ups

Never let a lead go cold again

THE PROBLEM

Leads fall through the cracks when follow-ups depend on memory or sticky notes.

THE SOLUTION

Your CRM automatically logs every interaction and triggers follow-up reminders, emails, and tasks.

TOOLS TO USE

HubSpot CRM

Free CRM with automated sequences
Free / \$15/mo

Zapier

Connect your inbox to CRM automatically
Free / \$20/mo

Pipedrive

Visual pipeline with auto-reminders
\$14/mo

RESULT

0 missed follow-ups, 30% more closed deals

07

Reporting & Analytics

Know your numbers without building spreadsheets

THE PROBLEM

Pulling reports takes hours every month — and by the time you have them, the data is already old.

TOOLS TO USE

Google Looker Studio

Free dashboards from any data source
Free

Zapier + Google Sheets

Auto-log data as it happens
Free

THE SOLUTION

Connect your tools once. Dashboards update in real time. Weekly reports arrive in your inbox automatically.

Databox

Auto-reports sent to your inbox
Free / \$47/mo

RESULT

Real-time visibility with zero manual reporting

08

Customer Support / Chatbot

Answer questions 24/7 without being online

THE PROBLEM

Customers ask the same questions repeatedly — and every unanswered message is a lost lead.

TOOLS TO USE

Tidio

AI chatbot for your website
Free / \$29/mo

Claude AI

Train a custom AI on your business info
\$20/mo

THE SOLUTION

An AI chatbot on your website handles FAQs, qualifies leads, and books calls — even at 2am.

Intercom

Smart support + lead capture
From \$39/mo

RESULT

Handle 80% of inquiries without human input

09

Inventory & Order Alerts

Never run out of stock or miss an order again

THE PROBLEM

Tracking stock levels and order status manually leads to stockouts, delays, and unhappy customers.

THE SOLUTION

Automate inventory tracking with real-time alerts when stock runs low — and trigger reorder or supplier notifications automatically.

TOOLS TO USE

Cin7 / Sortly

Real-time inventory tracking & alerts
From \$39/mo

Google Sheets + Make

Custom inventory dashboard with auto-alerts
Free

Zapier

Trigger low-stock alerts to Slack or email
Free / \$20/mo

Shopify

Built-in inventory alerts for e-commerce
From \$29/mo

RESULT

Zero stockouts, 100% order visibility in real time

10

Employee Onboarding

Get new hires up to speed in half the time

THE PROBLEM

Manual onboarding takes weeks of HR time — documents, logins, training, and Q&A; repeated for every new hire.

THE SOLUTION

Automate the entire new hire flow: contracts, access setup, training materials, and check-ins — from day one.

TOOLS TO USE

Notion AI

Build an interactive onboarding hub
\$10/mo

Loom AI

Record and auto-summarize training videos
\$12.50/mo

DocuSign

Send and sign HR documents instantly
\$15/mo

Zapier

Trigger the full onboarding sequence on hire
Free / \$20/mo

RESULT

New hires productive 2x faster, HR saves 10+ hrs/hire

Ready to automate your business?

I help family businesses implement AI automation —
from outreach agents to full workflow automation.

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